

Year	Dollar amount
1917	\$1,000
1924	\$2,000
1931	\$4,000
1938	\$8,000
1945	\$16,000
1952	\$32,000
1959	\$64,000
1966	\$128,000
1973	\$256,000
1980	\$512,000
1987	\$1,024,000
1994	\$2,048,000
2001	\$4,096,000
2008	\$8,192,000
2015	\$16,384,000
2022	\$32,768,000

Pretty incredible, huh?

All you had to do was patiently invest this money for a little over a century, and instead of losing 96% of its purchasing power, it gained 3,112,292%.



You get paid in dollars, and you can and should use them for exchange. If you have to hold them for a few months, try a money market fund—they yield over 5% today. For a year or two, I prefer an actively managed investment-grade bond fund. For more than a few years, it is best treated by equity, preferably a broad, cheap, passive index.

I always dislike these one-sided arguments—*Come see how much the dollar has depreciated over a century!* At best, it's denominator blindness; at